

Students should have an understanding of:

4.1	Sikh teachings about the origins and value of the universe: scientific explanations for the origins of the universe and Sikh responses to them, including the compatibility of Sikh beliefs and science; divergent Sikh responses and teachings about the value of the universe in Sikhism, including Guru Granth Sahib 1037; responses to the possible view that the universe may be used as a commodity.
4.2	Sikh teachings about the sanctity of life: Sikh teachings about why human life is holy; Sikh teachings on the sanctity of life including Guru Granth Sahib 1239; divergent understandings of the importance of sanctity of life for Sikhs today.
4.3	Sikh responses to scientific and non-religious explanations about the origins of human life including evolution and survival of the fittest with reference to interpretations of Guru Granth Sahib 19; the significance of the responses to scientific and non-religious explanations, such as evolution and survival of the fittest, for Sikhs today.
4.4	Implications of the Sikh teachings about the value and sanctity of life for the issue of abortion: the nature of abortion; different Sikh teachings about the nature and use of abortion, including reference to Guru Granth Sahib 74 and whether life begins at conception; non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) arguments surrounding its use, including the application of ethical theories, such as situation ethics, and Sikh responses to them.
4.5	Sikh responses to the existence of death and the afterlife: Sikh teachings and beliefs that support the existence of a life after death; divergent Sikh responses to arguments for life after death (including remembered lives, including possible interpretations of Guru Granth Sahib 19, paranormal, logic, reward, comfort and meeting loved ones); the significance of arguments for belief in life after death for Sikhs.
4.6	Sikh responses to non-religious arguments against life after death: why Sikh reject arguments against belief in life after death (including as a source of comfort, lack of evidence, fraudulent accounts, social control), including Guru Granth Sahib 430.
4.7	Implications of the Sikh teachings about the value and sanctity of life for the issue of euthanasia: Sikh teachings about the nature and use of euthanasia, including reference to Lord Indarjit Singh's speech in the House of Lords on 12 December 2014 in the Lords' Debate on Assisted Dying; non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) arguments surrounding its use, including the application of ethical theories, such as situation ethics, and Sikh responses to them, including support for hospice care.
4.8	Sikh responses to issues in the natural world: Sikh responses to threats to the world, including pollution, global warming and the use of natural resources, including Guru Granth Sahib 1037; divergent Sikh responses to animal rights, including animal experimentation and the use of animals for food, and the application of ethical theories such as utilitarianism.

Paper 1: Area of Study 1 – Religion and Ethics

- First assessment: May/June 2018.
- The assessment is 1 hour and 45 minutes.
- The assessment is out of 102 marks.
- Students must answer all sections and all questions on the chosen religion. The religion must be different for each area of study.
- The paper may include short open, open response and extended writing questions.
- The paper will assess spelling, punctuation and grammar (SPaG) and use of specialist terminology and these will contribute a minimum of 5% of marks towards the overall weighting for this paper.

Synoptic assessment

Synoptic assessment requires students to work across different parts of a qualification and to show their accumulated knowledge and understanding of a topic or subject area.

Synoptic assessment enables students to show their ability to combine their skills, knowledge and understanding with breadth and depth of the subject.

Synopticity will be assessed where students are required to bring together their knowledge and understanding of religion from across the course of study.

Sample assessment materials

Sample papers and mark schemes for this paper can be found in the *Pearson Edexcel Level 1/Level 2 GCSE (9–1) in Religious Studies B* Sample Assessment Materials (SAMs) document.

Area of Study 2: Religion, Peace and Conflict

The focus of this area of study is on Religion, Peace and Conflict; this is one of three areas of study of which students must complete two.

For this area of study, students must study all four content sections in relation to one religion:

1. Beliefs
2. Crime and Punishment
3. Living the Religious Life